



Desert animals



With burning days, freezing nights, and no water, a desert is one of the harshest habitats on Earth. Even so, some animals manage to survive here.

Bactrian camel

Camels have adapted well to desert life. They can go without water for months.

Thick fur protects the camel from the burning sun.

Humps store fat for when food is scarce.

Nostrils can close to keep out sand.



Wide feet prevent sinking in soft sand.

Stomach stores water.

Desert reptiles



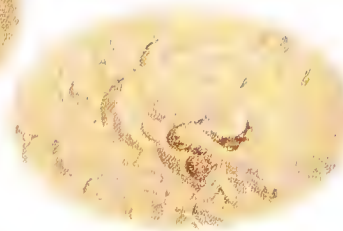
Lizard

Many reptiles live in the desert. Their scaly skin stops them from drying out.



Sand viper

To escape from the sun, the sand viper buries itself in sand.



Desert survival

Harris's hawks build their nests in the prickly branches of cacti.



Dwarf hamsters have thick fur to help them survive freezing desert nights.



Darkling wing beetles have white wings to reflect heat, keeping the insects cool.



Tadpole shrimps can survive under the sand for 10 years, waiting for rain to fall.

Scorpions hunt only in the cool of the night. They kill their prey with a deadly sting.



Did you know?

Male sandgrouse soak up water in their breast feathers and then fly back to their chicks, who drink it all up!

